

Thursday, 20 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Heavy drizzle

22° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

19° 14°

MANCHESTER

Rain

18° 14°

GLASGOW

Light rain

16° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Initial findings from an investigation into a recent train derailment near Lewes have revealed a track defect at the site.

The Rail Accident Investigation Branch is looking into the incident. An 'irregularity' was found, which could shed light on what caused the derailment.

TRANSPORT · UK

2 UK inflation has reached its highest rate in four months, driven by a significant jump in energy bills.

Economists had largely anticipated the 2.9% rise. Chancellor John Healey stated that the ongoing conflict in Iran continues to impact prices across the UK.

ECONOMY · UK

3 Thunderstorm warnings have been issued for several parts of the UK, with forecasters predicting potential flash flooding.

The warnings will come into effect later today, Wednesday, covering northern England, eastern Scotland, and Northern Ireland. Residents in these areas should prepare for heavy downpours.

WEATHER · UK

4 The Prime Minister has unveiled a new plan aimed at getting rough sleepers off the streets of England in time for Christmas.

The initiative will offer housing to those sleeping rough, drawing comparisons to the 'Everyone In' scheme launched during the pandemic. It's hoped to provide much-needed support as winter approaches.

SOCIAL POLICY · UK

5 The consumer watchdog is investigating Trainline, Virgin Atlantic, and RED Driving School over concerns about 'drip pricing'.

The Competition and Markets Authority wants to know if the companies are failing to show customers the full price upfront. This practice can lead to unexpected costs being added later in the booking process.

CONSUMER · UK

What's coming up

1 **Reading Festival has been granted an extension to its music hours despite some noise concerns from local residents.**

This year's festival, later this month, will feature headliners including Charli XCX, rapper Dave, and Chase & Status. It means festival-goers can enjoy the music for longer.

ON AIR – Are you heading to Reading Festival? Who are you most excited to see perform this year?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Welsh actor Matthew Rhys has admitted he was 'too scared' to talk to Harrison Ford about taking on the iconic role of Han Solo.**

Rhys, who hails from Cardiff, is set to voice Han Solo in a new release where the Empire speaks Welsh. It sounds like a dream role for any Star Wars fan!

ON AIR – If you could voice an iconic movie character, who would it be and why?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **For the first time ever, the National Television Awards have announced an all-female shortlist for their drama acting award.**

The five talented actresses vying for the prestigious award are Ella Bruccoleri, Sheridan Smith, Ruth Jones, Vicky McClure, and Judy Parfitt. It's a fantastic recognition of female talent in British drama.

ON AIR – Who do you think deserves to win the NTA for best drama actress this year?

AWARDS · COMING UP

4 **The winners of Love Island UK's twist-filled series have been crowned, following a dramatic final.**

This season saw a departure from tradition, with only three couples making it to the final stage after several unexpected twists. It kept viewers on the edge of their seats right to the end!

ON AIR – Did your favourite couple win Love Island this year? What did you make of all the twists and turns?

TV · THIS WEEK

5 **The Esports Nations Cup has been delayed until 2027, with organisers citing the ongoing conflict in Iran.**

They've stated that postponing the contest will allow them to deliver the high-quality event that fans truly deserve. It's a shame for gamers, but safety comes first.

ON AIR – Are you a big esports fan? What do you make of the Nations Cup being pushed back?

GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 Arsenal have reportedly agreed a deal worth over £50m to sign Aston Villa and England defender Ezri Konsa.

This major transfer move looks set to bolster Arsenal's defence ahead of the new season. Konsa has been a key player for Villa, making this a significant acquisition for the Gunners.

ON AIR – Arsenal fans, what do you make of the Ezri Konsa signing? Is he the player you needed?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Australian tennis star Nick Kyrgios has been provisionally suspended from the sport after testing positive for cocaine.

This news comes as a blow for the controversial but talented player, and for the tennis world. It means he'll be out of action for the foreseeable future.

ON AIR – What impact do you think this suspension will have on Nick Kyrgios's career?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK

3 England's cricket team is set to face Pakistan and Sri Lanka in a one-day international tri-series this October.

The matches will be played in Lahore and Rawalpindi. It promises to be an exciting series as England prepare for future international competitions.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to seeing England take on Pakistan and Sri Lanka in the tri-series?

CRICKET · UK

4 Joe Root has expressed his excitement at leading England again as captain for the opening Test against Pakistan.

Speaking this morning, Root said he's 'really excited' to be back in the captaincy role for a second time. He's called on his team to build on the foundations laid by former skipper Ben Stokes.

ON AIR – How do you feel about Joe Root returning as England's Test captain?

CRICKET · UK

5 World champion boxer Dalton Smith has revealed his dream of fighting at Sheffield Wednesday's Hillsborough ground next year.

The Sheffield native described fighting at the stadium as the 'cherry on the cake' after his homecoming. It would be a huge event for local boxing fans.

ON AIR – Would you like to see Dalton Smith fight at Hillsborough? What's your favourite local sporting venue?

BOXING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A poll finds the nation can't agree on the correct way to make a cup of tea.**
Milk first or last remains a genuine source of household tension. The one thing we agree on: someone else should make it.
- 2 Slow cookers are flying off the shelves again as energy-conscious shoppers rediscover them.**
They use a fraction of the power of an oven over a day. The downside: the smell of dinner from 9am tests everyone's patience.
- 3 More people are switching their morning scroll for a morning walk, apps suggest.**
Step-counters report a small but steady rise in early-morning activity. The motivation for most? A dog that refuses to wait.
- 4 A study says the average person walks past their phone over 50 times a day without picking it up.**
Researchers reckon just seeing it nearby is enough reassurance. The phone, meanwhile, remains entirely unbothered.
- 5 A survey finds most of us have at least one app we've never opened since downloading it.**
The average phone reportedly carries dozens of unused apps. Top of the 'meant to use it' pile: language-learning and meditation.
- 6 Pub quizzes are reporting record team sign-ups, with niche rounds drawing the crowds.**
Music and picture rounds are the great levellers. The cleverest team name still wins more goodwill than the actual answers.
- 7 Allotment waiting lists have hit record highs across the UK.**
Councils in some areas now quote waits of several years. The most-grown first crop for beginners? Courgettes — closely followed by regret, as they produce far too many.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 60% of us have a 'good' version of THIS we save for visitors.
ANSWER: THE NICE TOWELS NOBODY'S ALLOWED TO ACTUALLY USE.

Q Asked the most annoying noise in everyday life, the top answer was THIS.
ANSWER: SOMEONE ELSE'S PHONE ON FULL VOLUME ON THE TRAIN.

TALK TOPIC

- **New research says the average person has visited fewer than half the places on their own doorstep.**
What's the famous local spot you've still never been to despite living nearby for years?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** Carrots were originally purple. The familiar orange carrot was cultivated later, and is often linked to Dutch growers from around the 16th and 17th centuries.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Cornish bakery has launched a pasty so large it legally has to be sold with its own carry-handle and a food-safety leaflet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China isn't actually visible from space without aid, despite the myth.
- There are more possible games of chess than atoms in the observable universe.
- A flock of crows is called a 'murder'.
- The unicorn is mentioned in the Bible nine times.
- Coca-Cola would be green if colouring wasn't added to it.
- A day on Venus is longer than a year on Venus.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water under certain conditions — it's called the Mpemba effect.

On this day

Day 232 of the year, 133 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Amadour; Christian feast day: Bernard of Clairvaux; Christian feast day: Blessed Georg Häfner; Christian feast day: Heliodorus of Bet Zabdai. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1986 — Andrew Surman, South African-English footballer
- 1975 — Shaun Newton, English footballer
- 1974 — Amy Adams, American actress
- 1976 — Tony Grant, Irish footballer
- 1941 — Dave Brock, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1977 — Wayne Brown, English footballer
- 1979 — Jamie Cullum, English singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1989 — Judd Trump, English snooker player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1988 — The Troubles: Eight British soldiers are killed and 28 wounded when their bus is hit by an IRA roadside bomb in Ballygawley, County Tyrone.
- 2016 — Fifty-four people are killed when a suicide bomber detonates himself at a Kurdish wedding party in Gaziantep, Turkey.
- 2006 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Tamil politician and former MP S. Sivamaharajah is shot dead at his home in Tellippalai.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1905 — Sun Yat-sen, Song Jiaoren, and others establish the Tongmenghui, a Republican, anti-Qing revolutionary organisation, in Tokyo, Japan.
- 1991 — Dissolution of the Soviet Union, August Coup: More than 100,000 people rally outside the Soviet Union's parliament building protesting the coup aiming to depose President Mikhail Gorbachev.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Tamil politician and former MP S. Sivamaharajah is shot dead at his home in Tellippalai.

- 1998 — The Supreme Court of Canada rules that Quebec cannot legally secede from Canada without the federal government's approval.
- 1968 — Cold War: Warsaw Pact troops invade Czechoslovakia, crushing the Prague Spring. East German participation is limited to a few specialists due to memories of the recent war. Only Albania and Romania refuse to participate.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 233 of the year, 132 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Abraham of Smolensk (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian Feast Day: Bernard of Alzira; Christian Feast Day: Cyriaca; Christian Feast Day: Euprepus of Verona. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Alicia Witt, American actress and musician
- 1941 — Jackie DeShannon, American singer-songwriter
- 1988 — Kacey Musgraves, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1993 — Millie Bright, English footballer
- 1956 — Kim Cattrall, English-Canadian actress
- 1949 — Loretta Devine, American actress and singer
- 1971 — Liam Howlett, English keyboard player, DJ, and producer
- 1989 — Hayden Panettiere, American actress (died 2026)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2000 — American golfer Tiger Woods wins the 82nd PGA Championship and becomes the first golfer since Ben Hogan in 1953 to win three majors in a calendar year.
- 1945 — Physicist Harry Daghljan is fatally irradiated in a criticality accident during an experiment with the Demon core at Los Alamos National Laboratory.
- 1988 — The 6.9 Mw Nepal earthquake shakes the Nepal–India border with a maximum Mercalli intensity of VIII (Severe), leaving 709–1,450 people killed and thousands injured.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1140 — Song dynasty general Yue Fei defeats an army led by Jin dynasty general Wuzhu at the Battle of Yancheng during the Jin–Song Wars.
- 1942 — World War II: The Guadalcanal campaign: American forces defeat an attack by Imperial Japanese Army soldiers in the Battle of the Tenaru.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)